

DROPPED OBJECT PREVENTION TOOLBOX TALK

Prevent tools, materials and equipment from falling to lower levels.

8-10 MINUTES

OBJECTIVE

Review injury, equipment-damage and production-loss hazards caused by tools, materials and equipment falling from height, scaffolds, platforms and lifting areas, and verify tethering, exclusion-zone and lower-area controls before work begins.

TOPIC EXPLANATION

- Even a small nut, wrench or hand tool can cause serious injury when dropped from height. The severity depends on the object's weight, drop height, shape and impact point.
- Tools must be secured with suitable tool lanyards, small parts kept in closed containers and loose materials kept away from platform edges. Toe boards alone do not eliminate every dropped-object hazard.
- The area below must be barricaded and kept clear of personnel. Materials must be raised, lowered and passed using controlled methods and must never be thrown from one level to another.

REALISTIC SITE SCENARIO

- A worker left a wrench close to the edge of a scaffold platform while completing a connection task. The tool was not secured.
- While repositioning, the worker contacted the wrench with a foot and it fell to the level below. A nearby worker was exposed because the lower area had not been fully barricaded.
- The incident could have been prevented through tool tethering, closed tool bags, effective exclusion control and a dropped-object inspection before starting.

REMEMBER

Every tool and material used at height can fall. Secure it, contain it, barricade the area and keep people out of the line of fire.

DROPPED OBJECT PREVENTION TOOLBOX TALK

Hazards, control measures and daily pre-work verification.

8-10 MINUTES

KEY HAZARDS

- Unsecured hand tools and small components.
- Materials left near scaffold or platform edges.
- Missing toe boards or edge protection.
- Open tool bags and unsafe material handling.
- Personnel working in the area below.
- Loose or unstable loads during lifting.
- Lightweight materials moved by wind.
- Materials thrown between levels.

CONTROL MEASURES

- Secure tools with suitable tool lanyards.
- Keep small parts in closed bags or containers.
- Do not leave loose materials near platform edges.
- Check toe boards, netting and edge protection.
- Barricade the lower area and create an exclusion zone.
- Raise and lower materials using controlled methods.
- Secure loose components before moving loads.
- Assess wind conditions and lightweight materials.
- Clean platforms completely after the task.
- Stop work when dropped-object risk is identified.

SUPERVISOR TALKING SCRIPT

Team, no tool or small component used at height will remain unsecured today. Tools will be tethered, small parts kept in closed bags and materials kept away from platform edges. The area below will remain barricaded and clear. We will stop work if wind, missing toe boards or loose materials create a hazard.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- Which tools will be used at height today?
- Are tool lanyards and attachment points suitable?
- How will small components be carried and stored?
- Is the lower area completely barricaded?
- Are any loose materials present near platform edges?
- How will work stop if a dropped-object hazard is identified?

VERIFY BEFORE STARTING TODAY

- | | |
|---|--|
| ☐ Tools tethered | ☐ Tool bags closed |
| ☐ Small parts secured | ☐ Toe boards complete |
| ☐ Edge protection suitable | ☐ Lower area barricaded |
| ☐ Loads secured | ☐ Wind acceptable |
| ☐ Platform clean | ☐ Team briefed |

ATTENDANCE AND APPROVAL

DROPPED OBJECT PREVENTION TOOLBOX TALK

Project / Site

Date

Presented by

Work area

No	Full Name	Company / Role	Signature
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			
6			
7			
8			
9			
10			
11			
12			
13			
14			

Supervisor notes / additional site instructions